

Choose a reference database from the biological question

Then lock release, marker region, and classifier before comparing labels.

Broad SSU coverage

Environmental surveys
Bacteria + Archaea + Eukaryota
Conservative rank interpretation



SILVA 138.2

Genome-linked taxonomy

Bacteria + Archaea
Genome phylogeny nomenclature
Audit missing or discordant SSU



GTDB R232

Tree-native integration

Amplicon + shotgun studies
Unified phylogenetic backbone
Do not confuse with Greengenes 13_8



Greengenes2 2024.09

Fair comparison: same 366 V4 ASVs · same 515F/806R extraction · same exact-sequence LCA dereplication

Same consensus-VSEARCH identity, query coverage, strand, top-hit, and consensus thresholds